

RUNNER A.P.E.R

Player's Manual

Athens Piraeus Electric Railways · for the Amstrad CPC 6128 · disc



Runner A.P.E.R

Loading

1. Switch on your Amstrad CPC 6128 (128K is required).
2. Insert the **RUNNER** disc, side A, into the drive.
3. Type **RUN"RUNNER** and press **RETURN**. (**RUN"DISC** works too.)

First the REVIVE8BIT screen appears: press **SPACE** to go on, or wait 10 seconds. Then the loading screen appears while the game loads. After a few seconds the main menu comes up.

Your high scores are saved on the disc. Do **not** write-protect it if you want to keep your records.

The story: The Last Souvlaki Man

It's 6:47 a.m. in Kiato. Your uncle Babis, the finest souvlaki man in Piraeus, has just called you in a total panic. At noon the judge of the "Golden Skewer" contest arrives at his shop, and Babis has left Grandma's secret spice in Kiato: a little jar labelled "DO NOT TOUCH, BABIS".

You head for the suburban train. It's cancelled "due to the unforeseen presence of a goat on the line". There's no taxi either, because the only taxi driver in Kiato is Babis himself.

So you run along the tracks with the jar in your pocket. You jump the buffer stops. You climb onto the roofs of trains that, strangely, run perfectly on time for everyone except you. You grab coins for the ticket you never had time to buy.

The ticket inspector has been chasing you since Loutraki. So has the goat.

If you don't make it, Babis will season the skewers with supermarket oregano. In Piraeus, that is never forgiven.

RUN!

The main menu

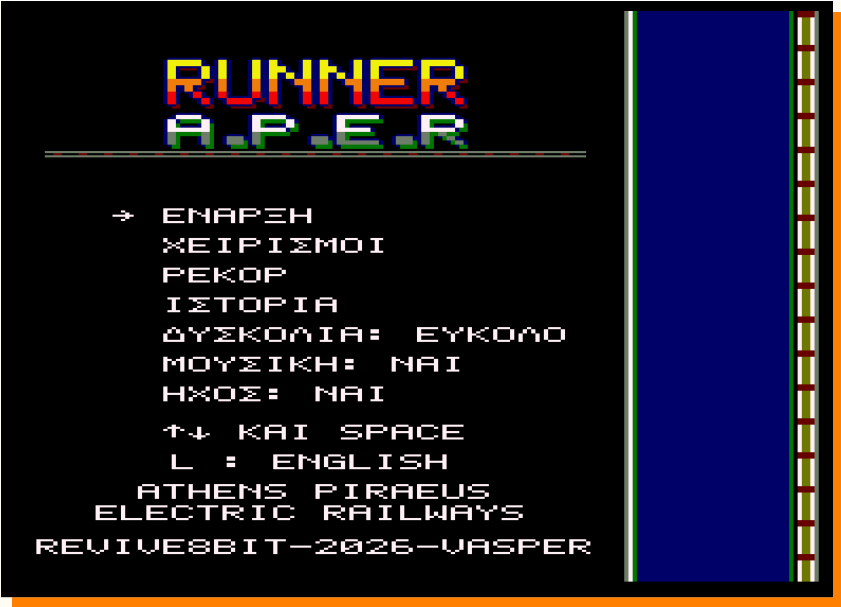


The main menu

Move with **↑ ↓** (or the joystick) and choose with **SPACE**, **FIRE** or **RETURN**.

Option	What it does
START	Starts a run
CONTROLS	Shows the keys
HIGH SCORES	The 8 best runners
STORY	Why on earth you are running
DIFFICULTY	EASY / MEDIUM / HARD
MUSIC	Tunes on or off
SOUND	All sound on or off

Press **L** to switch between English and Greek. If you leave the menu alone for a while, the game shows a **demo**; press any key to come back.

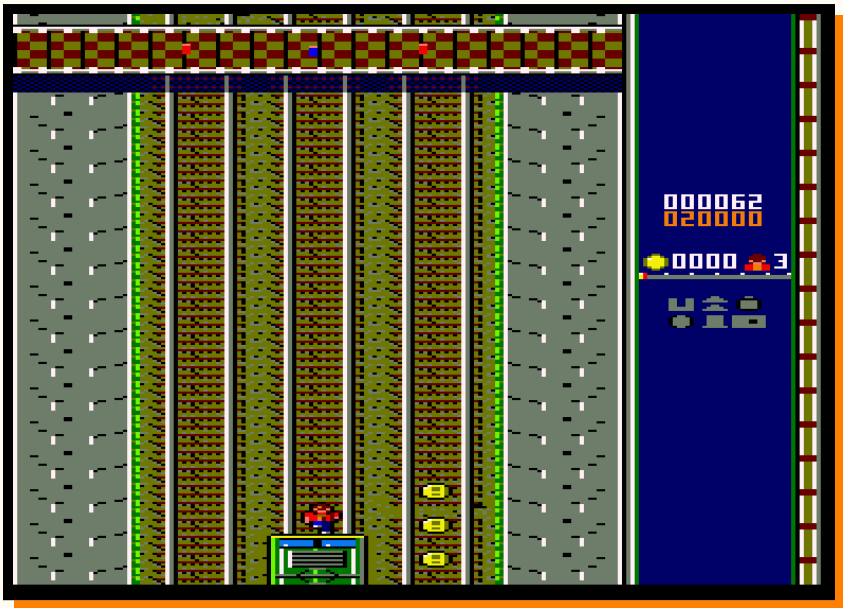


The menu in Greek

Controls

Action	Keyboard	Joystick
Move one lane left	← or O	left
Move one lane right	→ or P	right
Jump	↑, Q or SPACE	up or FIRE
Land quickly	↓ or A	down
Pause / continue	H	—
Music on/off	M	—
Give up, back to the menu	ESC	—

Playing the game



In the city

You run at the bottom of the screen and the line comes towards you from the top. There are **three tracks**. Change lane to dodge what is ahead, jump to clear it, and pick up every coin you can. While you are in the air you fly **over** coins and power-ups and don't collect them, so time your jumps.

Every run starts with a countdown: **3, 2, 1, GO!** On **HARD** the game first warns you to jump between the wagons.



The countdown on HARD

The line runs through the **city**, beside a busy avenue, and out into the **forest**. Footbridges and road bridges pass overhead. The longer you run, the more crowded the tracks get.



In the forest

Difficulty

Level	Speed	Special
EASY	normal	Obstacles get denser slowly, never more than 2 on one track in a screen; trains stand still
MEDIUM	about 20% faster	Obstacles get denser faster; trains move on the left track
HARD	faster still	Trains move on both side tracks, and you must jump the gaps between wagons when you run on the roofs

Heights

The runner gets bigger on screen the higher he is.

Height	Where you are
1	On the ground
2	Jumping from the ground: clears buffer stops
3	On a train roof
4	Jumping on a roof, over the wagons
5	The highest jump above a train

Lives

You have **3 lives**. After a crash you are protected for a moment. When the last life is gone, the game is over.



The screen

The track takes up three quarters of the screen. The panel on the right is the train's dashboard:

- your **score** (white) and the **best score** (orange);
- your **coins** and the **lives** left;
- the **route** from Kiato to Piraeus: the yellow stretch is behind you, the red mark is you;
- all six **power-ups**: grey when you don't have them, lit with a time bar while they run;
- on the right, a little **track** that runs with you: the station boards go by on it.

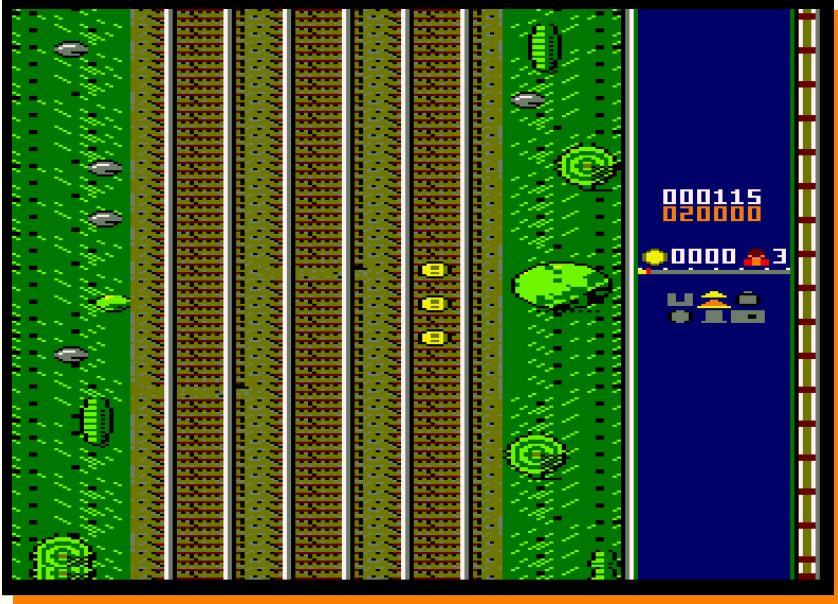
The route

You run from Kiato to Piraeus: **Corinth, Megara, Elefsina, Aspropyrgos, Rentis, Piraeus**. The bell rings and the station's name appears on the track as you pass it. **Piraeus gives 1000 points**, and then the route starts again.



Power-ups

A power-up turns up every 50 to 150 rows, never right in front of an obstacle. Some sit on the train roofs: take the ramp to reach them. When you take one, its name appears in the middle of the screen.



A power-up

Power-up	Effect	Lasts
Coin	10 points	—
TURBO	2 lines per frame faster, distance counts double (the most common)	8 s
SLOW	Half speed: a breather	8 s
MAGNET	Pulls in the coins of the lanes next to you	10 s
SUPER JUMP	Jump from the ground right over a train	10 s
HELMET	Saves you from one crash	until hit
2X COINS	Every coin is worth double	15 s

TURBO and SLOW cancel each other.



Obstacles

Obstacle	How to get past
Wagon	Change lane, run up a ramp, or use the SUPER JUMP
Gap between wagons	On HARD only: jump it when you run on the roofs
Locomotive	Don't meet one head-on at ground level!
Oncoming train	On the right track (HARD): it comes at you faster than the track; get out of its way
Train ahead	On the left track (MEDIUM and HARD): it runs your way, slower, and you catch up with its back end
Ramp	Takes you up onto the roof; the end of the train takes you back down
Buffer stop	Jump it or change lane
Signal	Green: go on. Red: change lane, fast

The signal bell rings when a signal ahead turns red.

Scoring and high scores

`score = distance (x2 with TURBO) + coins x 10 (x2 with 2X COINS)`

If your score makes the top 8, type your initials: ↑ ↓ choose a letter, **SPACE** accepts it. The table is saved on the disc, so the records are still there next time.



Game over

Hints and tips

- Coins on a train roof mean a ramp is near: go up and collect them.

- Don't jump too early: in the air you miss the coins.
- Keep the HELMET for the crowded stretches. It is used up on the first crash.
- SLOW is your friend on HARD when the tracks get full.
- Watch the signals from far away: a red light leaves you little time.

Credits

REVIVE8BIT · 2026 · VASPER

Runner A.P.E.R: Z80 code, graphics, music and story written for the Amstrad CPC 6128. Inspired by the Athens–Piraeus electric railway (Line 1).

No goats were harmed in the making of this game.